

ple at Jerusalem, and brought vnto Baby-
lon) be restored, and brought agayne vnto
the temple at Jerusalem to their place in the
house of God.

W Get you farre from them therfore, thou
Chahnai captayne beyonde the water, and
Scharbuzanai, and poure councelers: Apher
sechei, which are beyonde the water, get ye
awaye from the. Let the worke of y^e house
of this God alone, that the captayne of the
Jewes and their Elders maye buylde y^e hou-
se of God in his place. I haue commaunded
what shalbe done to the Elders of Iuda for
the buylding of the house of God, that there
shalbe diligent hede take of the kynge's good-
des, euen of the rentes beyonde the water, ad
geue vnto the men, that they be not hyndred.
And yf they haue nede of calves, rammes &
lambes, for the burnt offeringe of the God
of heauen, wheate, salt, wyne and oyle, af-
ter the custome of the prestes at Ierusalem,
let the same be geuen them daylie with out
anye delaye, that they maye offre swete sa-
uours vnto the God of heauen, and praye
for the kynge's lyfe, and for his chyldre. And
soch a commaundement haue I geuen that
what man soeuer he be that altereth this
worde, there shall a beame be taken fro y^es
house, and set vp, and he shalbe hanged the-
ron, and his house shalbe made adoughyll
for the same thyng.

E And the God that set his name there, de-
stroye all kynge's, & people, that put to their
hande to alter, & to breake downe y^e house of
God which is at Ierusalem. I Darius haue
commaunded, that this be done with spede.

Then Chahnai the captaine of the coun-
trei beyonde the water, and Scharboznai
with theyr councelers (to whom kynge Da-
rius had sent) did their diligence: And y^e El-
ders of the Jewes builded, and they prosper-
ed thorow the prophecieng of Aggeus the
prophet and zachary the sonne of Iddo: and
they builded, and layed vp the foundation,
according to the comaundement of the God
of Israel, and after the commaundement of
Cyrus, and Darius & Artaxerxes kynge's
of Persia. And the house was fynished the
thyrde dave of the moneth Adar, euen in the
syfte yere of the raygne of kynge Darius.

* (i. Dar. vii. b)

* And the children of Israel, y^e prestes,
the Leuites, and the other children of the ca-
ptiuite helde the dedicacion of this house of
God with ioye, and offered at the dedicacion
of this house of God, and hundred oxen, two
hundred rammes, foure hundred goates: ad
for the reconcilinge of all Israel twelue he
goates, accorpyng to the nombre of the tri-
bes of Israel, & set the prestes in their son-
dyr courses, & the Leuites i their diuerse offi-
ces to minister vnto God at Ierusalem, as
it is written in the boke of Moyses.

And the children of the captiuite helde
Passouer vpon the fourtenth dave of y^e fyrst
moneth: for the prestes and Leuites were
purified, so that they were all cleane toge-
ther, and kylled Passouer for all the childre
of the captiuite, and for their brethre y^e pre-
stes, and for them selues. And the children of
Israel which were come agayne out of cap-
tiuite, and all soche as had separated them
selues vnto them from the fylthynesse of the
hyethen of the lande: to seke the Lorde God
of Israel, did cate, and helde the feast of vn-
leuened bread seven dayes with ioye: for the
Lorde had made them glad, and turned the
hert of y^e kynge of Assur vnto them, to streng-
then their handes in the worke of the house
of God, euen the God of Israel.

The vii. Chapter.

By the commaundement of Artaxerxes, Esdras
taketh his companions the chyldren of Israel, and
returneth to Ierusalem.



After these actes, there was in y^e A
raygne of Artaxerxes kynge of
Persia, one Esdras the sonne of
Saraiah, the sonne of Asaria,
the sonne of Helkia, the sonne of
Sallum, the sonne of Zadoc, the sonne of Ahi-
tob, the sonne of Amaria, the sonne of Asa-
ria, the sonne of Meraioth, the sonne of ze-
raia, the sonne of Izi, the sonne of Bucki, y^e
sonne of Abisua, the sonne of Phinehes, the
sonne of Eleazar, the sonne of Aaron y^e chefe
prest. This Esdras also went vpp from Ba-
bilon, and was a perfite scribe in the lawe of
Moyses, * which the Lorde God of Israel did
geue. And the kynge gaue him all that he re-
quyred, because the hande of the Lorde was
God was vpon him. And there went vpper-
tayne of the children of Israel, of the pre-
stes, Leuites, syngers, porters, ad of the Ne-
thiniims vnto Ierusalem, in the seventh yere
of kynge Artaxerxes. And he came to Je-
rusalem in the fyfth moneth, euen in the se-
uenth yere of the kynge. For vpon the fyrst
dave of the fyrst moneth, beganne he to go
vpp from Babilon: & on the fyrst dave of the
fyfth moneth came he to Ierusalem, because
the good hande of God was vpon him. For
Esdras prepared his hert to seke the lawe of
the Lorde, and to do it, and to teach the pre-
cept and iudgement in Israel.

And this is the coppe of the letter, y^e kynge
Artaxerxes gaue vnto Esdras the prest &
scrybe, which was a wyrtter of the wordes
and commaundementes of the Lorde and of
his statutes ouer Israel. Artaxerxes a king
of kynge's, vnto Esdras the prest & scrybe
of the lawe of the God of heauen, peace and
salutacion. I haue comaunded, that all they
of the people of Israel, and of the prestes
and Leuites in my realme (which are mpy-
ded of their awne good wyll to go vpp to Je-
rusalem)

rusalem) go with the: and therfore art thou
sent of the kynge and of his seven councelers,
to vset Iuda and Jerusalem, accordeinge to
the lawe of thy God, which is in thy hande:
And that thou shuldest take with the syluer
and golde, which the kynge and his counce-
lers offre of their awne good wyll vnto the
God of Israel (whose habitacyon is at Je-
rusalem) and all the syluer and golde y^e thou
canst fynde in all the countre of Babylon, w
it that the people offre of theyr awne good
wyll and the prestes geue for the house of
theyr God which is at Jerusalem.

E Take thou the same, and bye diligently
with the same money, oxen rammes, and la-
bes, with their meate offerings and drinck-
offerings, and thou shalt offer them vpon
the altare of the house of youre God which
is at Jerusalem. And loke what it lyketh the
and thy brethzen to do with the remnaut of
the money, that do after the wyll of youre
God. And the vessels that are geuen the for
the ministraciō in the house of thy God, those
deliuer thou before God at Jerusalem.

And whatsoeuer thyng moze shall be ne-
cessary for the house of thy God, which is ne-
cessary for the to spende, thou shalt receaue
the charges out of y^e kynge's treasure house.
I kynge Artaxerxes haue commaunded all
the treasures beyonde the water, that loke
whatsoeuer Esdras the prest and scrybe in
the lawe of the God of heauen, requireth of
you, that ye fulfyll the same spedyly, vntyll
an hundred talentes of syluer, vntyll an hu-
dred quarters of wheate, and tyll an hundred
Batthes of wyne, & tyll an hundred * Bat-
thes of oyle, & salt without measure. What-
soeuer also belongeth to the lawe of the God
of heauē, let the same be done without anye
delaye for the house of the God of heauē, that
he be not wroth agaynst y^e realme, & agaynst
the kynge, and his chyldren.

And we certifye you, that ye haue no au-
ctozite to requyre taxinge and custome, and
yearly rentes vpon any of the prestes, Le-
uites, syngers, porters, Nethiniims ad mini-
sters in the house of his God. And thou Es-
dras (after the wysdome of thy God, that
is in thy hande) sett iudges and arbiters (by
my auctozite) to iudge all the people that is
beyonde the water, euen all soch as knowe y^e
lawe of thy God: ad the that knowe it not,
those se that ye teach. And whosoever wyll
not fulfyll the lawe of thy God, ad the kyn-
ges lawe, let him haue his iudgement with-
out delaye, whether it be vnto death, or to be
rooted out, or to be condemned in goodes, or
to be put in preson.

* Blessed be the Lorde God of oure fa-
thers, which so hath inspired y^e kynge's hert,
to garnyssh the house of the Lorde, that is at
Jerusalem: and hath enclyned his mercy vnto

to me in the presence of the kynge, & his coun-
celers, and before all the kynge's hye estates.
And I was comforted (euen as the hande of
the Lorde my God was vpon me) & so gea-
thered I the heades of Israel together, that
they myght go vpp with me.

The viij. Chapter.

The nombre of them that returned to Ierusalem
with Esdras.

These are the principall fathers of A
the, and this is their register that
wente vpp with me from Babilō,
what tyme as kynge Artaxer-
ses raygned. Of the chyldren of
Phinehes, Serlom: of the chyldren of Itha-
mar, Daniel: of the chyldren of Dauid, Ba-
tus: of the chyldre of zecania amonge the chil-
dre of Pharos, zachary, and with him were
nōbred an hundred and fyfte men. Of the
chyldren of the captayne of Moab, Elioenai
the sonne of zerahia, and with him two hun-
dred men. Of the chyldren of zechania the
sonne of Jahasiel, and with him thre hundred
men. Of the chyldren of Adin, Abed the son-
ne of Jonathan, and with him fyfte men. Of
the chyldre of Elam, Isai the sonne of Atha-
lia, and with him seuentie men. Of the chyldre
of Saphatia, zebadia the sonne of Michael,
and with hym foure score men.

Of the chyldre of Joab, Obadia the sonne
of Jehiel, and with hym two hundred and
eyghtene men. Of the chyldren of Selomith
the sonne of Iosephia, and with him an hu-
dred and thre score men.

Of the chyldren of Brbai, zachary the son-
ne of Sebai, and with him eyght and twen-
tie men. Of the chyldren of Agad, Johanan,
the sonne of Hakatan, and with him an hu-
dred and ten men. Of the chyldren of Adoni-
cam, that were the last, whose names were
these: Eliphelet, Jehiel and Samaiab, and
with them thre score men. Of the chyldren of
Bignai, Athai, and zabud, and with the se-
uentie men. And I gathered them together
by the water that renneth towarde Abana,
and there abode we thre dayes. And I looked
amonge the people and the prestes & founde
there none of the children of Levi. Then sent
I to Eliezer, to Aziel, Semcia, Elnathan,
Tarib, Elnathan, Nathan, zachary and to
Besullam the rulers, and to Joarib ad El-
nathan which were men of vnderstandyng,
and to those gaue I commaundement vnto
Iddo the cheffest at Casphia, that they shulde
fetch vs ministres for y^e house of oure God,
and I tolde them what they shulde saye vn-
to Iddo, and to his brethzen the Nethiniims
at Casphia.

And (thorow the good hāde of oure God
vpon vs) they broughte vs a wyse man fro
amonge the children of Moab the sonne of
Leui, the sonne of Israel, and Sarabia with
hys

hys sonnes and his brethren, euen eyghtene. And Hasabiah, and with him Ilat of the children of Merari, with his brethren and they sonnes, twentie. And of the Rechinims, who David & the Princes gaue to mynister vnto the Leuites, two hundred & twenty of Rechinims, which all were named by name.

And euen there at the water, besyde Abana, I proclaimed a fast, that we myghte humble oure selues before oure God, and seke of him a ryghte waye for vs, and for oure children and for all oure substance. For I was named to requyre of the kynge, souldiers & horsen, to helpe vs agaynst the enemy in the waye: but we sayd vnto the kynge: The hande of oure God is vpon all the that seke hym in goodnes, and (hys domynion) hys violence and wrath is agaynst all them that forsake hym. So we fasted, and besought oure God for this, and he heard vs.

And I toke out twelue of the chiefe preastes, Sarabiah and Hasabiah, and ten of their brethren with them, and weyed them syluer and golde, & vessels that were appoynted for the house of oure God, which the kynge and his counsellors and his Lordes, and all Israell that were there at hande, had geuen together. And I weyed vnto their hande six hundred & syftie talentes of syluer, & in syluer vessel an hundred talentes, & in golde an hundred talentes: twentie basens of golde of a thousande peces, and two costly ornaments of good brasse, as cleare as golde: and I sayde vnto them: Ye are consecrate vnto the Lorde, lyke as the vessels are holy also, and the golde and syluer are geue of a good wyll vnto the

Lorde God of youre fathers. Watch ye, and kepe it: for ye shall weye it downe before the chiefe preastes and Leuites, and auncient fathers of Israell at Ierusalem in the treasuries of the house of the Lorde. Then toke I preastes and Leuites that weyed syluer and golde and vessel, to bringe it to Ierusalem, vnto the house of oure God. And we brake vp, from the water of Abana on the tweluen daye of the fyrst moneth, to go vnto Ierusalem: and the hande of oure God was vpon vs, and deliuered vs from the hande of the enemy, and of such as layde wayte for vs by the waye.

And we came to Ierusalem, and abode there thre dayes. But on the fourth daye was the syluer and golde and vessel weyed in the house of oure God, by the hande of Meremoth the sonne of Uziah the preaste, and with hym was Eleazar the sonne of Phinehes, & with them was Josabab the sonne of Iesua, and Noadiah the sonne of Benoi the Leuites. According to the nombere and weyght of euery one, was the weyght all wyrtten vp at the same tyme.

And the children of the captiuite, which were come out of prison, offered burnt offe-

rynges vnto the God of Israell: twelue bullockes for all Israell, syxe and nyntye rammes, seuen and seuentie lambes, twelue he-goates for a synofferynge, all to the burnt-offerynge of the Lorde. And they deliuered the kynges commission vnto the kynges officers, & to the capitaynes that were on thys syde the water. And they promoted the people and the house of God.

The ix. Chapter.

Esdas complayneth on the people that had turned them selues from God, and married with the gentiles.



When these thynges were done, the rulers came to me, and sayde: The people of Israell, and the preastes, and Leuites are not separated from the people of the landes (as touchynge their abhominacions) namely of the Cananites, Hethites, Pherezites, Jebusites, Ammonites, Moabites, Egyptians, and Amozites. For they haue taken the daughters of the same to the selues and to their sonnes, and the holy sede is mixte with the nations in the lande: and the hande of the princes & rulers hath bene principall in this trespass.

And when I heard this saying, I rete my clothes and my rayment, and I luckte of the heer of my heade, and of my beerd, and late mourninge. And there resorted vnto me all such as feared the wordes of the Lorde God of Israell, because of the trasgression of the people of the captiuite. And I late mourninge vntill the euenynge sacrifice. And aboute the euenynge sacrifice, I rose vp from my benynges, and rente my clothes and my rayment, and fell vpon my knees, and spred out my handes vnto the Lorde my God, and sayde.

O my God, I am ashamed, and darre not lyfte vp myne eyes vnto my God: for oure wyckednesses are growne ouer oure heed, and oure trespase is waxen greete vnto the heauen. Sence the tyme of oure fathers haue we bene in greete trespase vnto this daye, and because of oure wyckednesses haue we and oure kynges bene deliuered into the hande of the kynges of the nacionys, into the swerde, into captiuite, into shame, and into confusio of face, as it is to se this daye.

And now is there a lytle & sodayne graciousnes come from the Lorde oure God, in causynge some of vs to escape, and that he maye geue vs a nape in hys holy place, and that oure God maye lyghte oure eyes, and geue vs a lytle lyfe to take bryth in oure bondage. For we are bondme, & oure God hath not forsaken vs in oure bondage, and hath enclined mercy vnto vs in the syghte of the kynges of Persia, to geue vs lyfe, to lett vs the house

the house of oure God, and to redresse the desolacion therof, and to geue vs a wall in Iuda and Ierusalem.

And now, O oure God, what shall we saye after this: for we haue forsaken thy commaundementes, whych thou hast commaunded by thy seruantes the prophetes, sayeng: The lande vnto which ye go to possesse, it is an vncleane land, because of the fylthynes of the people of the landes, whych with theyr abhominacions haue made it full of vncleanness on euery syde. Therefore shall ye not geue poure daughters vnto their sonnes, and their daughters shall ye not take vnto poure sonnes, ner seke their peace & welth for euer, that ye maye be strong, & enioye the good in the land, & ye & poure chyldren maye haue the inheritaunce of it for euermore.

And after that all these thynges are come vpon vs (because of oure euell dedes & greete trespasses) thou oure God hast thrust downe oure wickednesses, & hast geue vs a deliuerance, (as it is cometo passe this daye.)

And yf we turne backe agayne, to let go thy commaundementes, and make contracte with the people of these abhominacions, wilt thou not then be wroth at vs (as not without cause) tyl we be utterly consumed, so that no thyng remayne, and tyll there be no deliuerance? O Lorde God of Israell, part ryghteous, for we remayne yet escaped, at it is to se this daye. Behold also, in thy presence are we in oure trespasses, & because of it maye we not stande before the.

The x. Chapter.

The people repente, and tume, and put awaye theyr straunge wyues.



And when Esd. 2. prayed after this maner, & knowleged, wepte, & laye before the house of God, there resorted vnto him out of Israell a very greete congregacyon of men and women, and chyldren: & the people wepte very sore. And Sechania the sonne of Jehiel one of the children of Elam, answered, and sayde vnto Esd. 2. We haue trespassed agaynst oure God, and haue taken straunge wyues of the people of the land. Now there is hope yet in Israell concerning this thyng: for now we wyll make a couenaunt with oure God, and put awaye all the wyues (and such as are borne of them) accordinge to the counsell of the Lorde, and we wyll be in the feare of the commaundementes of oure God, that we maye do accordinge to the lawe. Get the vp, for thys matter belongeth vnto the. we also wyll be with the, be of good conforte therefore, and do it.

Then rose Esd. 2. and toke an oth of the chiefe preastes and Leuites, and of all Israell, that they shulde do accordinge to thys worde: & they sware. And Esd. 2. stode vp

from before the house of God, and went into the chamber of Iohanan the sonne of Eliafib. And when he came thither, he dyd eate no bred, nor dranke water: for he mourned because of the trasgression of the people that had bene in captiuite.

And they caused a proclamacyon to go thorow out Iuda and Ierusalem, vnto all the chyldren which had bene in captiuite, & they shuld geather the selues togeather vnto Ierusalem. And that whosoener came not wyth in thre dayes accordinge to the deuys of the rulers and Elders, all hys substance shulde be forfett, and he shulde be put out fro the congregacyon of the captiue.

Then all the men of Iuda and Ben Jamin geathered them selues togeather vnto Ierusalem wythin thre dayes, euen the twentie daye of the nyenth moneth: and all the people sat in the strete before the house of God, and trembled because of thys matter, & for the rayne. And Esd. 2. the preaste stode vp, and sayde vnto them: Ye haue trasgressed, & made a trespase of Israell yet more: confesse now therefore vnto the Lorde God of youre fathers, and do hys pleasure, and separate poure selues from the people of the land, & from the straunge wyues. And all the congregacyon answered, and sayd with a loude voyce: It shalbe so, and we will do as thou hast sayde.

But the people are many, and it is a rayne whether, and the people are to saynt to tarve without in the strete, neither is this a worcke of one daye or two, for we haue offended very sore in this thyng. Let oure rulers stand therefore in all the congregacyon, and lett all them whych haue taken straunge wyues in oure cyties come at the tyme appoynted, and let the Elders of euery cytie and they Judges be with them, tyll they haue turned the wrath of oure God awaye from vs concerning this matter.

Then were appoynted Jonathan the sonne of Abiel, and Jahalia the sonne of Shekua ouer thys matter: And Josullani and Sabatha the Leuites helped them. And the chyldren of the captiuite dyd euen so. And Esd. 2. the preast, and the auncient heades thorow the house of theyr fathers, all men of great fame, separated the selues, and sat them downe on the fyrst daye of the tenth moneth, to examen the matter. And vntill the fyrst daye of the fyrst moneth they were synnyng the busyness wyth all the men that had taken straunge wyues.

And amonge the chyldren of the preastes there were men founde that had taken straunge wyues, namely amonge the chyldren of Iesua the sonne of Josedec and of hys brethren, Maliah, and Eliezer, Jariab and Gedalia, and they gaue theyr handes there

of Daseah, and Mesulam the sonne of Beso-
dia, they layde the beames therof, and set on
the dozes, lockes and barres of it. Nexte un-
to them, buylded Malatiah of Gibeon, and
Jadon of Merano, men of Gibeon, and of
Milsa, where he that was captayne of this
syde the water had a mansion. Nexte unto
him buylded Asiel the sonne of Harhahab &
goldsmith. Nexte unto him also buylded ha-
naniah the sonne of Harakahim, and they re-
payred Jerusalem vnto the brode wall. Nexte
vnto them buylded Rappahiah the sonne of
Hue, the ruler of the halfe parte of Jerusa-
lem. Nexte vnto him buylded Jedania the son-
ne of Harumaph ouer agaynst his house: ad
nexte vnto him buylded Hatus the sonne of
Hasabnia. But Melchiah the sonne of Harim
and Hasub & sonne of the captayne of Moab
buylded the other pece, and the tower besyde
the fornaces. Nexte vnto him buylded Sal-
lum a spynners sonne, the ruler of y^e halfe par-
te of Jerusalem, he and his daughters.

The valley gate buylded Hamun, & the
cysterns of zanoa. They buylded it, and set
on the dozes, lockes and barres therof, and a
thousande cubites on the wall, vnto y^e won-
ge porte. But the wonge porte buylded Mel-
chiah the sonne of Rechab, the ruler of the
fourth parte of Bethchar: he repayed it, ad
set on the dozes, lockes and barres therof.
But the wellgate repayed Shallu the son-
ne of Chohobah, the ruler of the fourth parte
of Milsa. He buylded it, and layed the bea-
mes, and set on the dozes, lockes, and barres
therof, and the wall vnto the pole of Siloah
by the kynges garden, and vnto the steppes
that go downe from the cyttie of Dauid. Af-
ter him buylded Nehemiah the sonne of A-
bub, the ruler of the halfe parte of Bethzur,
vntyll the other syde ouer agaynst the sepul-
chres of Dauid, and to the pole that was re-
payred, and vnto the house of the myghtie.

After him buylded the Leuites, Rehun
the sonne of Bani: and nexte vnto him buyl-
ded Hasabia the ruler of the halfe parte of
Reilah in hys quarter. After hym buylded
they brethren. Banai the sonne of Henadad
the ruler of the halfe parte of Reilah: and af-
ter hym buylded Ezer the sonne of Iesua the
ruler of Milsa the other pece, harde ouer a-
gaynst the goynge vp to the house of ordi-
nauce that was in the corner. Agayne, af-
ter hym brake forth Baruch the sonne of za-
chal of indignacyon, and repayed the other
pece from the turnyng corner vnto the doze
of the house of Eliasib the hye prest. After
hym also buylded Merimoth the sonne of
Aria the sonne of Hacos the other pece, from
the doze of the house of Eliasib, euen as
longe as the house of Eliasib extended. Af-
ter hym buylded the prestes, the men of the
playne. After hym buylded Beniamin and

Hasub ouer agaynst theyr house: and after
hym wrought Asaria the sonne of Maasia
the sonne of Anania nexte vnto hys house.
After hym also buylded Benut the sonne of
Hanadad the other pece, from the house of
Asaria vnto the turnyng of the wall, and
vnto the corner.

After hym buylded Pala & sonne of Asai
ouer agaynst the corner and the hye tower,
which lyeth out ouer from the kynges hou-
se, that was besyde the courte of the prison.
After hym buylded Phedania the sonne of Pharhos
(as for y^e Bethinims they dwelt in the strōg
holde vnto the watergate, towarde the east,
and to the tower that lyeth out.) After hym
buylded they of Chelua the other pece ouer
agaynst the greete tower, that lyeth out
warde, vnto the wall of the stronge holde.

But from aboue the horsgate forth, buyl-
ded the prestes, euery one ouer agaynst his
house. And after the buylded zadok the son-
ne of Immer ouer agaynst his house. After
hym buylded also Semeia the sonne of Se-
chania the keper of the Eastgate. After him
buylded Hanania the sonne of Selemia, and
Hanun the sonne of zalaph the syxte, the
other pece. And after him buylded Mesula
the sonne of Barachia ouer agaynst his sto-
re house. After him buylded Malachia the
goldsmithes sonne, vntyll y^e house of Bethi-
nims, and of the merchautes ouer agaynst
the gate of Bephrad, and to the parlor in the
corner. And betwene the parlour of the cor-
ner vnto the Shepegate buylded the gold-
smithes and the merchautes.

The. iij. Chapter.

The buyldynge of Jerusalem is hyndred and let,
but the Jewes buylded it, bringe readye harnesse,
lest theyr enemyes shoulde invade them.

But when Sanabalat heard
that we buylded the wall, he
was wroth in hym selfe, and
toke greete indignaciō, & mo-
cked y^e Jewes, and sayde be-
fore his brethren & the soul-
diers of Samaria: what do
these impotent Jewes? wyll the bethen suffre
them? Shall they offre? Shall they persourne
it in one daye? Shall they make y^e stones whole
agayne that are brought to dust, and brent?
And Tobiah y^e Ammonite was besyde him,
ad sayde: Though they buylde, yet yf a fore
go vp, he shall breake downe theyr stonpe
wall. Heare (O thou oure God) for we are
despised, turne their shame vpon their awne
heade, & geue the ouer into despisyng in the
lande of their captiuitie. Couer not their wic-
kednesse, & let not their synne be put out i thy
presence: for they haue prouoked y^e buylders.
And so buylded we the wall, & it was ioy-
ned whole together, vnto y^e half beygth ther
of. And the people were mynded to labour.

And

And it fortuned, y^e when Sanabalat, and
Tobiah, & the Arabians, Ammonites, & Mo-
odites heard, y^e the walles of Jerusalem were
mad vp, and y^e the gappes begane to be stop-
ped, they were very wroth, & conspired all to-
gether to come, & fyght agaynst Jerusalem, ad
to make the people an hynderaunce therein.
Nevertheless, we made our prayer vnto our
God, & set watchmen by the, which buylded
daye & nyght ouer agaynst them. And Juda
sayd: the strength of the bearers is to feble, &
there is yet moch moze moxter, & we are not
able to buyld on the wall. And our aduersa-
ries sayd: they shall not knowe nether se, tyll
we come in the middes amōge the, and slaye
the, and hinder the worke. But it fortuned
y^e when the Jewes (which dwelt besyde the)
came, they tolde vs as good as ten tymes, y^e
in all places where ye go vnto, they are ap-
pointed to fal vpo vs. Therefore let y^e peo-
ple after their kiredes wth their swordes, spea-
res & bowes bench in y^e lowe places behynd
the wal, & I looked, & gat me vp, & sayd vnto
the chefe me, to y^e rulers, & to y^e other people,
be not ye afrayed of the, * but thincke rather
vpo the greete Lord, whych ought to be fea-
red, & fight for your brethren, your sonnes, y^e
daughters, your wines, & your houses. Ne-
uertheles, it chaūced that when our enemyes
hearde, that we had gotten worde of it. God
brought their coucel to naught, & we turned
all agayne to y^e wal, euery one vnto his labo.
And fro that tyme forth it came to passe y^e the
half parte of the yong men did the labour, &
the other half parte of the helde the speares,
shylde, bowes, and brest plates: & the rulers
stode behynde all the house of Juda, which
buylded on the wall, and bare burthens fro
those y^e laded the. With one hande dyd euery
one worke, & wth the other helde he hys wea-
pō. And euery one y^e buylded, had his sword,
gyrd by hys thygh, ad so buylded they. And
the trompet blew besyde me.

* Ezo xiiij. c

And I sayd vnto the principal men, to the
rulers, and to the other people: the worke is
great and large, & we are separated vpon the
wall one farre from another. Loke in what
place therfore ye heare the noyse of the trom-
pet, resorte ye thither vnto vs, * & our God
shal fight for vs, & we will be labouryng in
the worke. And the halfe part of the helde y^e
speares fro y^e mozynng spyng, tyll the star-
res came forth. And at the same tyme said I
vnto the people: euery one abyde with hys
seruaunt at Jerusalem, that in the night seaso
we maye watch, and labour on the daye ty-
me. As for me and my brethren, my seruau-
tes, and the me of the watch (which were be-
hynde me) we put neuer of oure clothes, no-
moze then the other dyd theyr harnesse, saue
onely because of the water.

The. v. Chapter.

The people are vexed with hongre. The re-
quyeth not the buyng of a captayne.

Ad there arose a great cōplaynte of y^e
people, and of theyr wyues agaynst
their brethren the Jewes. For there
were some that sayd: our sonnes and daugh-
ters and we are to many, therfore wyll we
take corne for the, y^e we maye cate, and lyue.
Some also there were that sayde: let vs lett
our landes, vyneyardes and houses to pled-
ge, and take vp corne in the darth. But som
there were that sayde: let vs borowe money
for the kynges trybute & that vpon our lan-
des and vyneyardes. Behold, oure bodies as
the bodies of oure brethren, and oure chy-
dren as theyr chyldren: elles shulde we sub-
due our sonnes and daughters vnto bonda-
ge, and some of oure daughters are subdued
vnto bondage all ready, & no strength is there
in houre hādes, and other men haue our lan-
des and vyneyardes.

And when I heard their cōplaynte and
soch wordes, it displeased me sore, ad I ad-
uised so in my mynde, y^e I rebuked the coun-
cellers, and the rulers, and sayde vnto them:
Euery one of you is to chargeable vnto hys
brother. And I brought a greete congrega-
cyon agaynst them, and sayd vnto them: we
(after oure abilitie) haue bought our brethren
the Jewes, which were solde vnto y^e heathē.
And wyll ye sell your brethren agayne vnto
the heathen, after that they haue bene selde
vnto vs? Then helde they theyr peace, and
coude fynde nothyng to answer.

And Nehemiah sayde: It is not good that
ye do. Dought ye not to walke in the feare of
God, because of the rebuke of the heathen y^e
are our enemyes? I and my brethren, and my
seruautes do lend them money & corne: but
as for vlturys, let vs leaue it. Therefore, this
same daye I pray you se that ye restore them
theyr landes agayne, theyr vyneyardes, oyl-
le gardes, and their houses, and remytte the
hyndred part of the money, of the corne, wyne
and oyle that ye haue wonne of them. Then
sayd they: we will restore the agayne, & wyll
requeyre nothing of the, and will do as y^e hast
spoken. And I called y^e prestes, & toke an oth
of them, y^e they shuld do so. And I shoke my
lappe, & sayde: God shalke out euery mā after
the same maner from hys house & labour, y^e
maynteyneth not this word: euen thus be he
shaken oute, and voyde. And all the congre-
gacyon sayde: Amen, and prayled the Lord.
And the people dyd so.

And fro the tyme forth y^e (the lyng) com-
mitted vnto me to be a captayne of the that
were in the land of Juda, euen fro the. xx. ye-
re vnto the. xxxij. yere of kyng Arthaxer-
ses (that is. xij. yere) I wth my brethren lyued
not of soch sustenance as was geue to a cap-
tayne. For y^e olde captaynes y^e were before
me,